

LOST IN A BALLAD!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #121

Playing ballads can be a scary thing for a lot of novice jazz players. It is very easy to lose our way, get ahead or get behind, and then end up lost in the form. And all this in just three measures! The answer isn't in chords and scales, or in learning to count better. The answer is in better phrasing, understanding where the music should move, and where the music should rest. Fix your phrasing, and you've fixed your ballad playing.

Thoughts on Phrasing a Ballad

- Play in two measure phrases, just as the lyrics are most likely phrased.
- A "two measure phrase" really means "one and a half measures of music," and then a rest.
- The space/rest you are leaving makes the many chord changes more manageable.
- The space/rest you are leaving creates one coherent thought, not run on sentences.
- The space/rest you are leaving invites the band to respond to you, to provide counterpoint.
- The space/rest you are leaving makes you sound musically mature. You sound confident.

#1 - The "A" section of Body And Soul

Chord progression for the "A" section of Body And Soul:

Staff 1: Ebm7 Bb13(b9) Ebm7 Ab7 Dbmaj7 Gb7 Fm7 Eo7

Staff 2: Ebm7 Ebm7/Db Cø7 F7(b9) Bbm7 Ebm7 Ab7 Dbmaj7 Fø7 Bb7(b9)

#2 - What YOU are thinking over the same "A" section

Chord progression for the "A" section of Body And Soul (What YOU are thinking):

Staff 1: Ebm7 Bb13(b9) Ebm7 Dbmaj7 Gb7 Fm7

Staff 2: Ebm7 Ebm7/Db Cø7 Bbm7 Ebm7 Ab7 Dbmaj7